

~30%

Global Renewable Energy in 2025

How Far Have We Come?

A data-driven overview of renewables in the global energy and electricity mix.

Source: Our World in Data | Ember (2026) | Energy Institute (2025)

~14%
of primary energy

~30%
of electricity

5M+
premature deaths/yr from fossil fuel air pollution

For Policy Analysts & Energy Strategists

75% of Global GHG Emissions Still Come from Fossil Fuels

75%

of global GHGs from fossil fuels

5M+

premature deaths/yr from fossil fuel air
pollution

**Since
Industrial Revolution**

fossil fuels dominate energy

Three-quarters of global greenhouse gas emissions come from burning fossil fuels for energy.

Fossil fuel combustion causes local air pollution responsible for at least 5 million premature deaths per year.

To reduce CO₂ emissions and air pollution, the world must rapidly shift toward low-carbon energy sources — nuclear and renewable technologies.

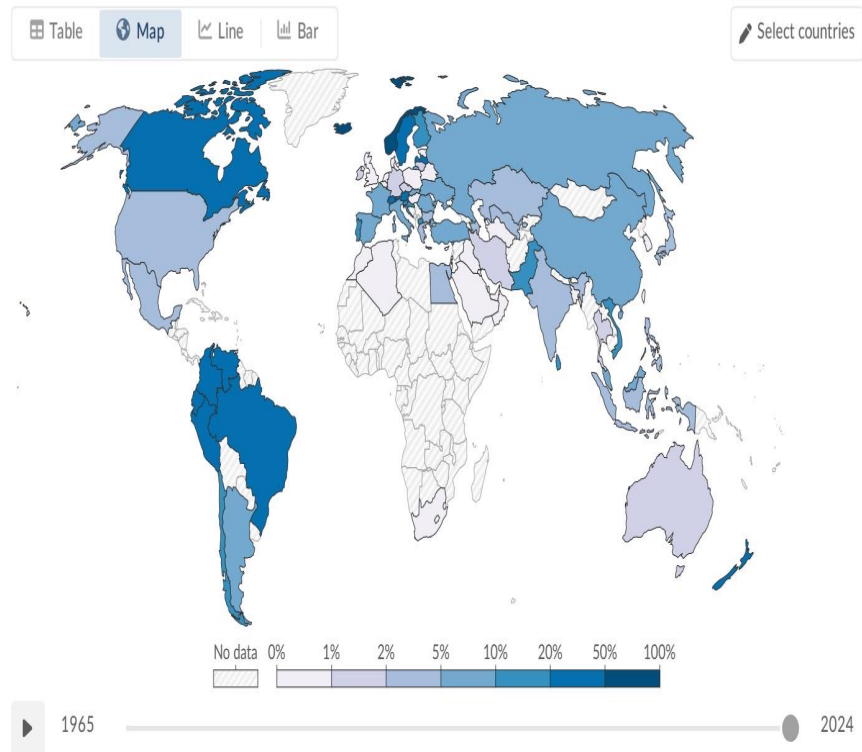
Renewables Now Supply ~14% of Global Primary Energy

~1/7

of primary energy is
renewable

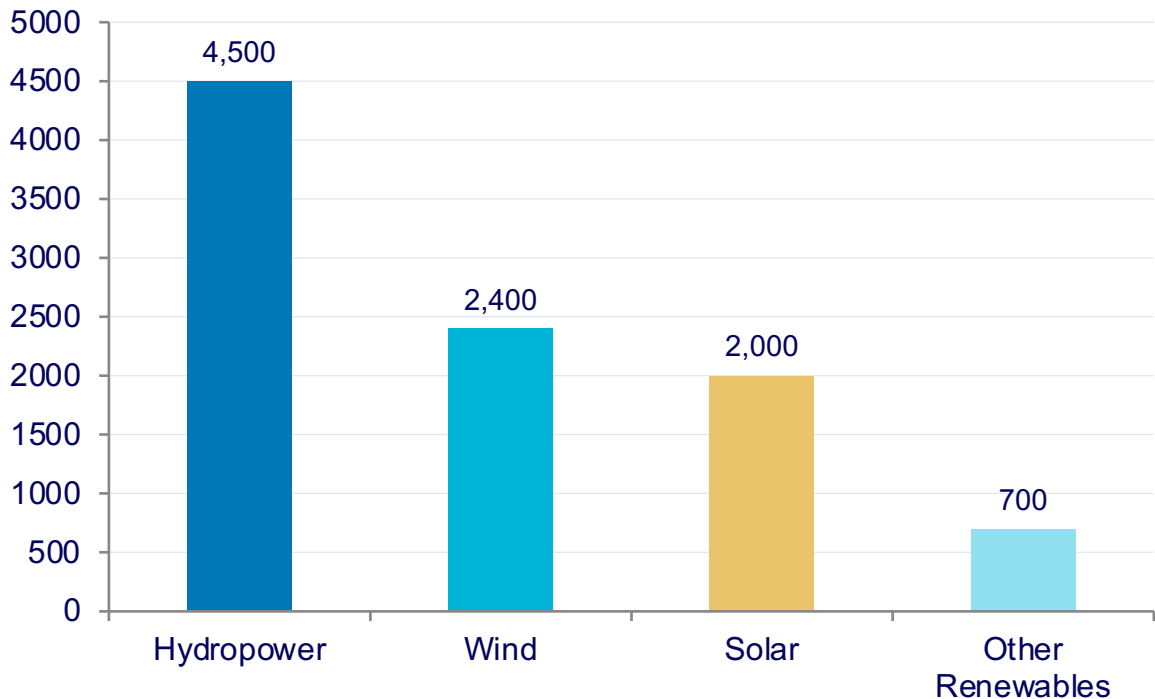
Primary energy = electricity + transport + heating combined. Transport and heating are harder to decarbonize, so the renewable share in total primary energy (~14%) is much lower than in electricity alone (~30%).

Regional leaders: Norway, Brazil, New Zealand. Fossil-fuel producers in the Middle East and parts of Asia remain below 5%.



Data source: Energy Institute - Statistical Review of World Energy (2025) - [Learn more about this data](#)
OurWorldinData.org/energy | CC BY

Renewable Electricity Generation: Wind & Solar Are Catching Up Fast



~9,600 TWh

total renewable electricity generation

Wind + Solar

~4,400 TWh combined — nearly matching
Hydro's ~4,500 TWh

Solar is the fastest-growing energy
technology in history, driven by falling
costs since 2010

Almost One-Third of Global Electricity Now Comes from Renewables

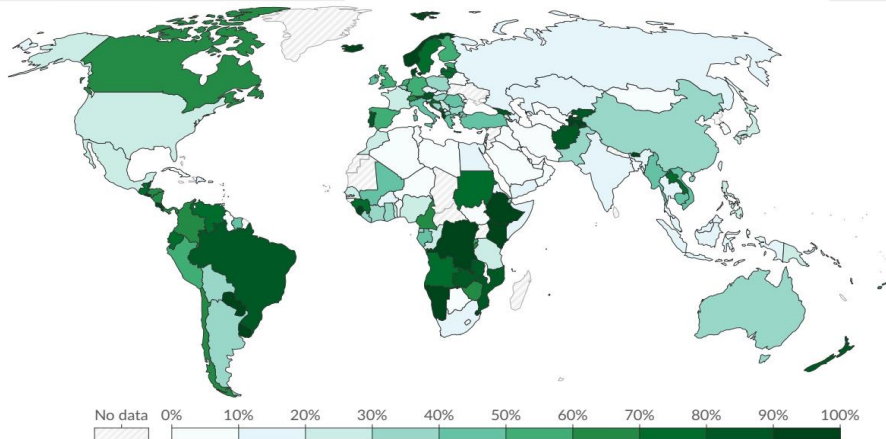
~30%

global electricity

Share of electricity production from renewables, 2025

Renewables include solar, wind, hydropower, bioenergy, geothermal, wave, and tidal sources.

Table Map Line Bar Select countries



Data source: Ember (2026); Energy Institute - Statistical Review of World Energy (2025) – [Learn more about this data](#)
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Source: Our World in Data | Ember (2026)

Renewable Share of Electricity

Country/Region	Renew. Share
Norway	~98%
Brazil	~85%
Canada	~65%
China	~35%
India	~25%
Saudi Arabia	<2%

Hydropower Remains the Largest Renewable Source at ~50% of Genera

~50%

of all renewable electricity

Hydropower has generated electricity at scale for over a century.

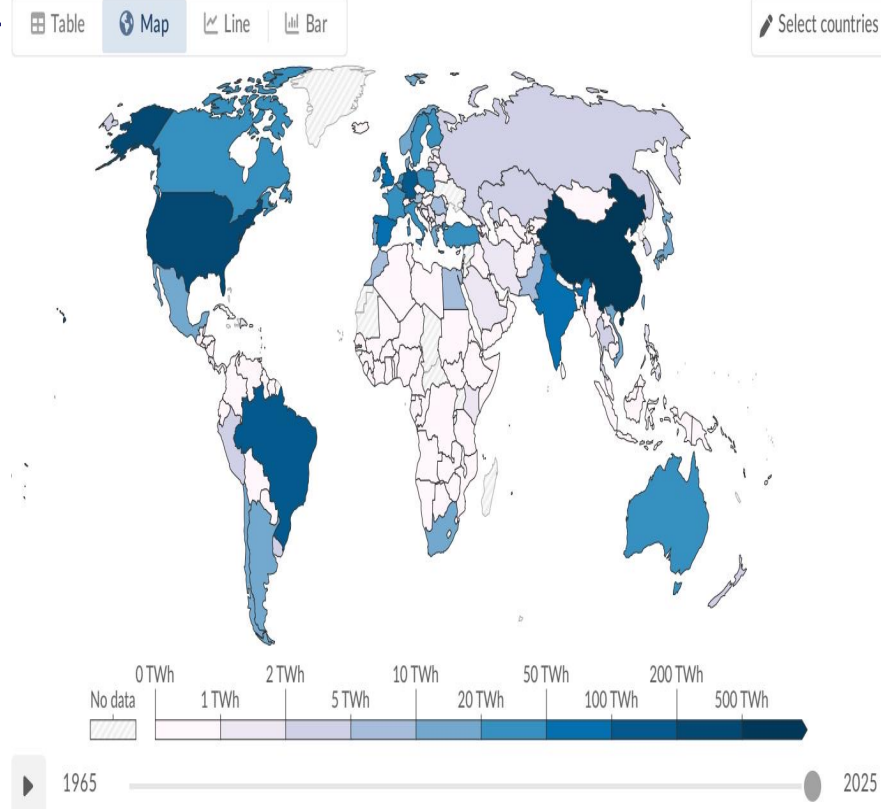
Top Producing Countries

China

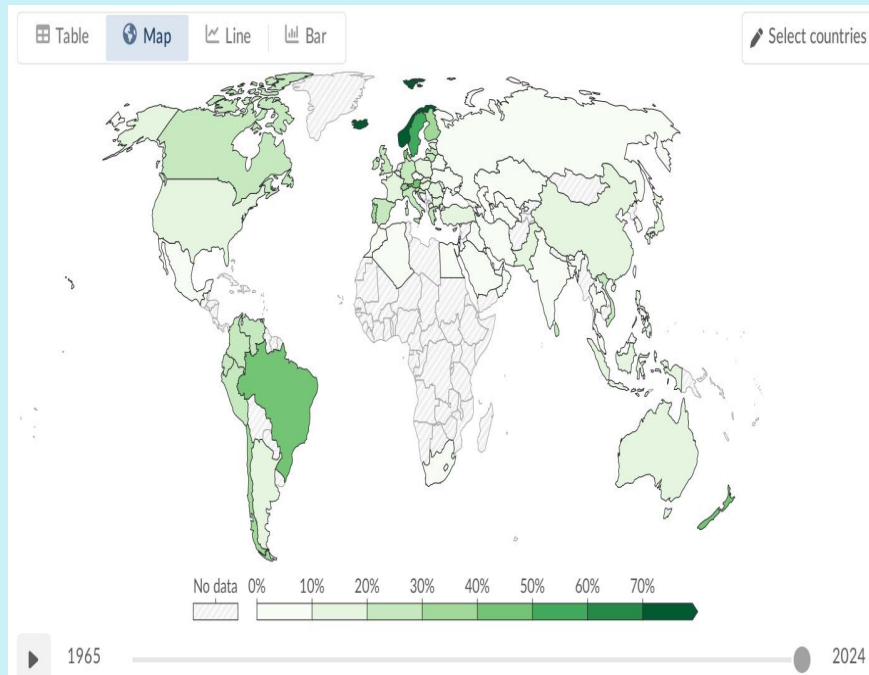
Brazil

Canada

Growth potential: While hydro is dominant today, its expansion is limited by geography and environmental constraints. Wind and solar are the key sources for future growth.



Wind and Solar Are the Fastest-Growing Energy Technologies in History



Wind power generation by country, 2025

Source: Our World in Data | Ember (2026)

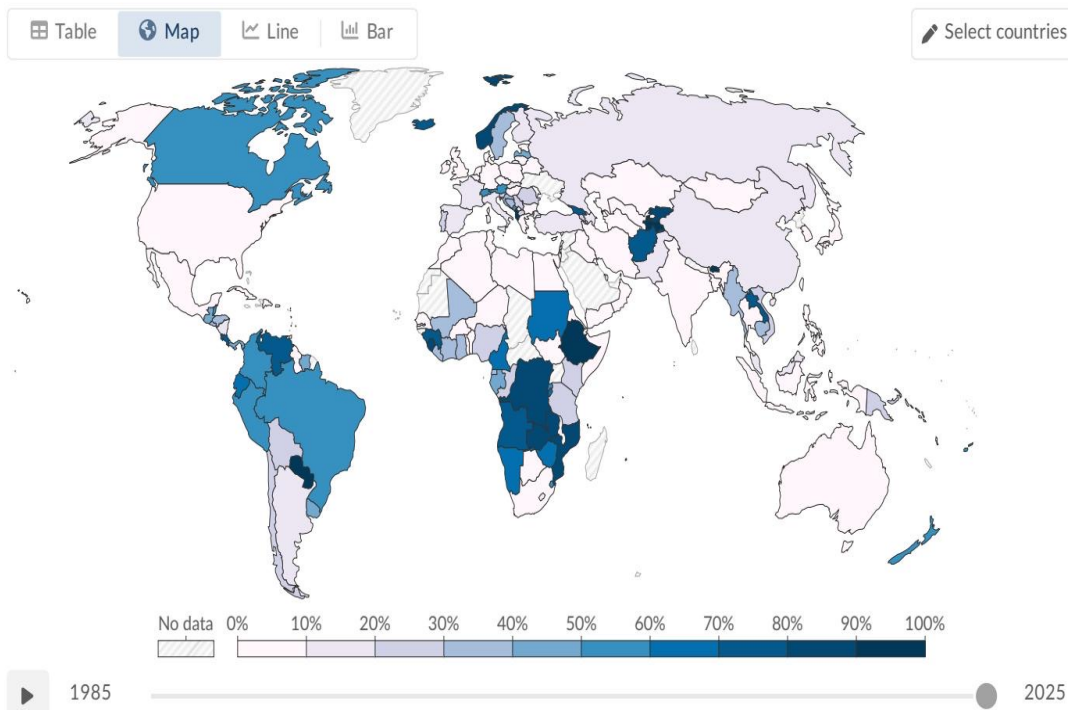
Wind vs. Solar Generation

WIND
~2,400
TWh
~25% of renewable electricity

SOLAR
~2,000
TWh
~21% of renewable electricity

Combined: ~4,400 TWh — nearly matching hydropower

Stark Regional Gaps: Scandinavia & Latin America Lead, Sub-Saharan Africa Lags



Share of electricity from hydropower by country, 2025

Source: Our World in Data | Ember (2026)

LEADERS

- Norway ~98%
- Brazil ~85%
- Canada ~65%

LAGGING

- Saudi Arabia <2%
- Sub-Saharan Africa <10%

Much of the Middle East and Sub-Saharan Africa remain almost entirely dependent on fossil fuels for electricity.

Key Takeaways

Renewables are growing fast — but the transition must accelerate

- 1 ~14% of primary energy and ~30% of electricity now come from renewables — significant but far from sufficient for climate targets.
- 2 Hydropower generates ~50% of all renewable electricity but has limited growth potential compared to wind and solar.
- 3 Wind (~2,400 TWh) and solar (~2,000 TWh) together now nearly match hydro and are the fastest-growing energy technologies in history.
- 4 Stark regional disparities persist: Scandinavia and Latin America lead at 65–98% renewable electricity; Middle East and Sub-Saharan Africa remain below 10%.
- 5 Transport and heating lag far behind electricity — the overall primary energy share (~14%) reflects how much further the full transition must go.